

ALTAMONT HEALTH SOLUTIONS - PRIOR AUTH DIV

P.O. BOX 992831, NORTH ARBOR, MI 48103
TELEPHONE: (800) 555-0199 | FAX: (800) 555-0120

PRIOR AUTHORIZATION DETERMINATION NOTICE

1. PATIENT IDENTIFICATION

PATIENT NAME: MARLOWE, JONATHAN Q.
DATE OF BIRTH: 04/12/1974
GENDER: M
MEMBER ID: AHS-9923844-01
GROUP NUMBER: BGR-5521

2. PROVIDER INFORMATION

REQUESTING PROVIDER: DR. ELIAS VANDER-WAAL, MD
NPI NUMBER: 1029384756
FACILITY NAME: ST. JUDE'S FICTIONAL MEDICAL CENTER
FACILITY TAX ID: 99-1234567
CONTACT PERSON: SARAH JENKINS (EXT 402)

3. CLINICAL DIAGNOSIS & CODES

PRIMARY ICD-10: M54.51 (Vertebrogenic low back pain)
SECONDARY ICD-10: G89.29 (Other chronic pain)
REQUESTED CPT CODE: 64633
MODIFIER(S): 50, RT, LT
DATE OF SERVICE (EST): 06/15/2026

4. MEDICAL NECESSITY SUMMARY

The patient presents with a 14-month history of recalcitrant lumbar discomfort focused at the L4-L5 levels. Conservative management including physical therapy (PT) for 12 weeks, NSAID therapy (Naproxen 500mg BID), and corticosteroid injections (02/10/2026) have failed to provide long-term symptomatic relief (>3 weeks). Radiographic evidence (MRI dated 01/05/2026) indicates moderate facet joint arthropathy with-out significant stenosis or myelopathy. Patient reports a visual analog scale (VAS) score of 8/10. Requested inter-vention: Radio-frequency ablation (RFA) of the medial branch nerves.

5. AUTHORIZATION DECISION

STATUS: PENDING CLINICAL REVIEW
AUTH REFERENCE NO: PA-8827334-XG
SUBMISSION DATE: 04/20/2026
DUE DATE: 04/27/2026

Note: Addtl documentation re: diagnostic medial-branch block results is req'd for final adjudication. The results must demon-strate at least 80% relief of pain post-procedure to meet Altamont policy criteria-302B.

6. CONTACT & APPEALS

If you disagree with this preliminary determination, please contact the Utilization Management Dept at (888) 555-9000. Written appeals can be sent to: APPEALS DIV, SUITE 400, 100 INDUSTRIAL PKWY, CLEARWATER, OH 44001. Ref: CASE-ID# 2291-BA.

Form: AHS-UM-2024-v4

Digitally Signed: _REVIEWER_SYSTEM_09_

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